

ACTIVITY 5 — FACILITATOR GUIDE

Control — Hold the Gain and Hand Over

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Hands-on Lab	30 minutes	CONTROL	Control — Hold the Gain

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to describe the control actions that sustain an improvement (A5, K2).

What learners produce

A completed control plan with a reaction plan, a visual board sketch, a short SOP, a daily huddle plan, and a one-page summary of the whole DMAIC story naming the process owner.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and framework
- Internet access where the activity calls for live research

Set-up

Groups of 3–5. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group, and make sure every group can open this activity's data/ folder. All 5 activities run on the same continuous BrewBean Cafe scenario and follow DMAIC in order, so remind learners where this activity sits in that story — and that its output feeds the next one.

Scenario / briefing material

The pilot worked. The countermeasure was made permanent and the improvement team was stood down. Four weeks later the team has been asked to review how it is holding up.

The daily figures have been collected throughout. Weeks 1 and 2 look good. In week 3 something goes wrong: a new opening staff member was never shown the restock step, the measure degrades for five consecutive days, and nobody notices until a customer complains publicly on the Friday. Week 4 recovers once the SOP is pinned up and the handover is done properly.

Most improvements work for a fortnight and then quietly disappear. Your job is to close the BrewBean Cafe story by deciding what will be measured from now on, who owns it, what happens when it slips, and how the improved process is handed back to the people who run it every day.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Choose the control measure. Open data/post-improvement-monitoring.csv — four weeks of daily figures after the pilot was made permanent. Choose the ONE measure that tells you the improvement is still working. One or two measures watched properly beat five that nobody looks at.	Project the week-3 rows and let the room find the drift before you name it.
2	Complete the control plan. Look at data/control-plan-example.csv for the worked first row, then complete templates/control-plan-template.csv: what is measured, the target, how often it is checked, where it is recorded, and who owns it. Name one role as owner — a control plan owned by 'the team' is owned by nobody.	Challenge every reaction plan that says 'investigate'. Ask what the supervisor physically does tomorrow morning.
3	Write the reaction plan. Write the exact steps to take when the measure misses target. 'Investigate' and 'escalate' are not reaction plans — say what the supervisor physically does tomorrow morning. Then find week 3 in the monitoring data and state which day your plan would have triggered on.	Draw out the leading-indicator point: the restock check goes wrong on Monday, but the wait time only breaches on Tuesday. A control plan built on the leading indicator buys the team a full day.
4	Design the visual board. Sketch a simple board that would have made the week-3 drift visible to the whole shift on day one. A run of the daily figure beats a single number, because drift shows up as a trend long before anyone calls it a problem.	Watch for control plans with no owner, or 'the team' as the owner. One named role.
5	Write the SOP. In templates/sop-and-huddle-template.csv, turn your Lab 4 standard work into a short SOP the cafe could actually pin up — and state how anyone would know the step was done.	Close the course with the week-3 story: five days, roughly 300 affected customers and a public complaint — prevented by one tick on a checklist and one glance at a board. Then have each learner read out the RESULT line from their summary.
6	Plan the daily huddle. Complete the huddle rows: who attends, what time, how long, what is reviewed and who runs it. Five minutes at the board is enough. The rule that makes huddles work: problems are named, not blamed.	
7	Summarise and hand over. Using templates/one-page-summary-template.csv, summarise the whole project — problem, cause, countermeasure, result and control — then name who you hand it over to and when. A White Belt project that stays with the improvement	

	team has not finished.	
--	------------------------	--

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
4 min	Choose the one measure that shows the gain is holding
9 min	Complete the control plan and the reaction plan
5 min	Design the visual board and write the SOP
5 min	Plan the daily huddle
7 min	Write the one-page summary and name the handover

Total: 30 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Looking at the monitoring data, which day would a good control plan have triggered on — and how many customers were affected before anyone noticed?
2. Which of your measures is a leading indicator and which is lagging? Why does the difference matter here?
3. What makes a reaction plan actionable rather than just a statement of intent?
4. Who should own this process now that the improvement team has disbanded, and why that person?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what they found.
- Link the activity explicitly back to DMAIC · CONTROL — Control — Hold the Gain.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- The countermeasure was correct and the improvement still decayed. What does that tell you about the Control phase?
- What would week 3 have looked like if the visual board had already been in place?
- Which improvement in your own workplace has quietly drifted back, and what control was missing?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- Project the week-3 rows and let the room find the drift before you name it.
- Challenge every reaction plan that says 'investigate'. Ask what the supervisor physically does tomorrow morning.
- Draw out the leading-indicator point: the restock check goes wrong on Monday, but the wait time only breaches on Tuesday. A control plan built on the leading indicator buys the team a full day.
- Watch for control plans with no owner, or 'the team' as the owner. One named role.
- Close the course with the week-3 story: five days, roughly 300 affected customers and a public complaint — prevented by one tick on a checklist and one glance at a board. Then have each learner read out the RESULT line from their summary.

Success criterion

Every group can show a control plan naming a measure, target, frequency and a single named owner; a reaction plan that says what to DO; and a one-page summary telling the complete DMAIC story from problem to named handover.

Assessment link

This activity builds CONTROL — Control — Hold the Gain. All 5 activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS) component, which reuses the same techniques on the same continuous BrewBean Cafe scenario. Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.